

Who really talks about cybersecurity on Bluesky?

WESTERN SYDNEY UNIVERSITY

Computer, Data and Mathematical Sciences

Text, clustering, hypothesis and network analysis of 6,188 Bluesky posts, 30 Sep – 5 Oct 2026

COMP3020 Social Web Analytics · Group 32 · Yousuf (20397249) · Seemrah (22175168) · Rishikanth (22170637)

Introduction

Cybersecurity news spreads fast on social media, but how much of it comes from people rather than automated feeds? We collected recent Bluesky posts matching “cybersecurity” or “infosec” and ran four linked analyses: what is said, in what forms, who gets attention, and who is connected to whom.

53%

of English posts came from bot accounts, almost all from one alert feed

32%

of the remaining posts came from just 10 feed accounts

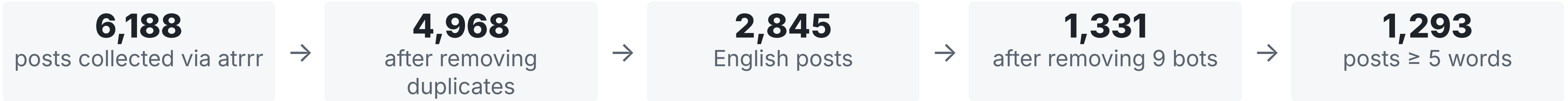
3.9×

higher engagement rate for human posts than for bot posts

0.4%

of accounts in a leading voice's network posted about the topic

Data and method



- 1 · Text

tidytext word counts; stop words, links and search terms removed
- 2 · Clustering

TF-IDF vectors, cosine distance, k-means with k = 6
- 3 · Hypothesis

$\chi^2$  test: account type × any engagement ( $\alpha = 0.05$ )
- 4 · Network

Directed follow network (igraph): 3,201 accounts, 3,619 edges

RQ1 A few feeds shape the vocabulary

Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts

Mostly from other accounts

| Word               | Frequency | Source                                         |
|--------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------|
| post               | 407       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| ai                 | 373       | Mostly from other accounts                     |
| ransomware         | 284       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| blog               | 218       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| ransom             | 192       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| title              | 192       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| cti                | 191       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| threatintelligence | 190       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| sector             | 152       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| security           | 146       | Mostly from other accounts                     |

8 of the 10 most frequent words come mainly from 10 feed accounts, such as template words “post”, “title” and “sector”. Among other accounts, AI leads the discussion.

RQ2 Six types of post, three are alert feeds

Posts from the 10 most active (feed) accounts

Posts from other accounts

| Category                      | Posts | Authors | Source                                         |
|-------------------------------|-------|---------|------------------------------------------------|
| General discussion            | 780   | 432     | Posts from other accounts                      |
| AI and security news          | 191   | 138     | Posts from other accounts                      |
| Ransomware leak-site alerts   | 190   | 2       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| CVE exploit alerts            | 52    | 3       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| German-language incident feed | 29    | 1       | Mostly from the 10 most active (feed) accounts |
| Cybersecurity job posts       | 19    | 12      | Posts from other accounts                      |

Three clusters come almost entirely from 1–3 alert accounts each. General discussion and AI news come from hundreds of authors.

RQ3 Bot posts get far less engagement

| Account Type   | Engaged posts (%) | n     |
|----------------|-------------------|-------|
| Bot accounts   | 14.5%             | 1,514 |
| Human accounts | 56.5%             | 1,293 |

$\chi^2 = 549.6$ , sim.  $p \approx 0.0005$ , so we reject independence. Human posts were engaged with 3.9 times as often as bot posts, although bots wrote over half the posts (an association, not a cause).

RQ4 A security voice in a non-security network

Seed account

Seed's 59 friends

Accounts they follow

Posted about the topic (12)

The seed is the most central account (top in-degree and betweenness). The other central accounts are individuals in tech, AI and academia. Only 13 of 3,201 accounts posted about cybersecurity.

Conclusion

Cybersecurity on Bluesky is high-volume but substantially automated. Bots and a few feed accounts produce much of the content, shape the vocabulary and form their own clusters. Human posts are far more likely to be engaged with, and the most-followed human voice sits in a broad tech and AI community.

Volume is not conversation: most posts are broadcast by machines, while engagement goes to people.

Limitations

- Five-day keyword sample, English only
- Bots found by handle and manual review, so some feeds remain
- Mentions too rare: follow network around one seed
- Engagement counted at collection time

Code and data:  
github.com/  
Yousuf963/  
comp3020-  
group32